

Debbie Amewu

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Law and Economics, Economics of Crime & Public Economics

EDUCATION

2022 - PRESENT Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina, United States
2019 - 2020 MSc. Economics, University of Warwick, Coventry, United Kingdom
2014 - 2018 B.A. Economics (First Class), University of Ghana, Legon, Ghana,

RESEARCH

Working Papers

1. “The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia”
2. “Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections”
3. “Do Prison Reforms Work: Evidence Based on the Justice Reinvestment Initiative”

Works In Progress

1. “Can Machine Learning Improve Pretrial Risk Assessment? Evidence from Virginia’s Public Safety Assessment”

SCHOLARSHIPS/AWARDS/GRANTS

2025 Darla Moore School of Business Research Grant, with Phil Brookins and Cooper Woodham (\$5,000)
2022 Graduate Assistantship at the University of South Carolina
2019 Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) Scholarship

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & ATTENDANCES

2027 (Scheduled)	American Economic Association conference, Washington, DC <i>The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia</i>
2026 (Scheduled)	Association of Public Policy and Management, Boston, MA <i>The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia</i>
2026 (Scheduled)	Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX <i>The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia</i>
2025	Association of Public Policy and Management, Seattle, WA <i>Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections</i>
2025	Interdisciplinary Policing Workshop, University of South Carolina, SC <i>Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections</i>
2024	Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, Clemson University, SC
2023	Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day, University of South Carolina, SC

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Primary Instructor:

- ECON 224 Introduction to Economics (Fall 2026)
- ECON 224 Introduction to Economics (Fall 2025)

Teaching Assistant:

- Public Finance ECON562 (Spring 2023)
- Principles of Microeconomics ECON221 (Spring 2023)
- Political Economy ECON516 (Fall 2022)
- Industrial Organization ECON515 (Spring 2023)
- Health Economics HSPM412 (Fall 2023, Spring 2024)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Experience

AUG 2024 - APR 2025	Research Assistant to Dr. Jessica Brown and Dr. Chris Herbst: “Impact of private equity ownership status on child care companies.”
AUG 2024 - DEC 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. Lindsey Woodworth: “The impact of sheriff characteristics on death investigations”.
MAY 2024 - AUG 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. David Fuente:- Projects involved analysing the impact of various experiments to encourage payment of utility bills in several African countries.
MAY 2024 - AUG 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. Orgul Ozturk
MAY 2023 - JULY 2023	Research Assistant to Dr. Felipe Saenz

Professional Experience

2020-2022	Consultant, Credit Administration Department, PwC, Ghana
2018-2019	Associate, Advisory LoS, PricewaterhouseCoopers Ghana Limited
JUNE - JULY 2017	Call Centre Intern, Dalex Finance and Leasing Company, Ghana

LANGUAGES

ENGLISH: Fluent
AKAN: Native

TECHNICAL SKILLS

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES Python, LATEX
SOFTWARE Stata, zTree, MS Office.

REFERENCES

Lindsey Woodworth (Committee Chair)

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University of South Carolina
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Sarah Walfogel

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Danna Thomas

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